instance of the `WebApplication` type is returned from the `builder.Build` method call in Program.cs. You pass in a route template and a *route handler*, a standard .NET `Delegate` that executes when the route matches. This can be a named function or a lambda expression that can take parameters (figure 11.5).

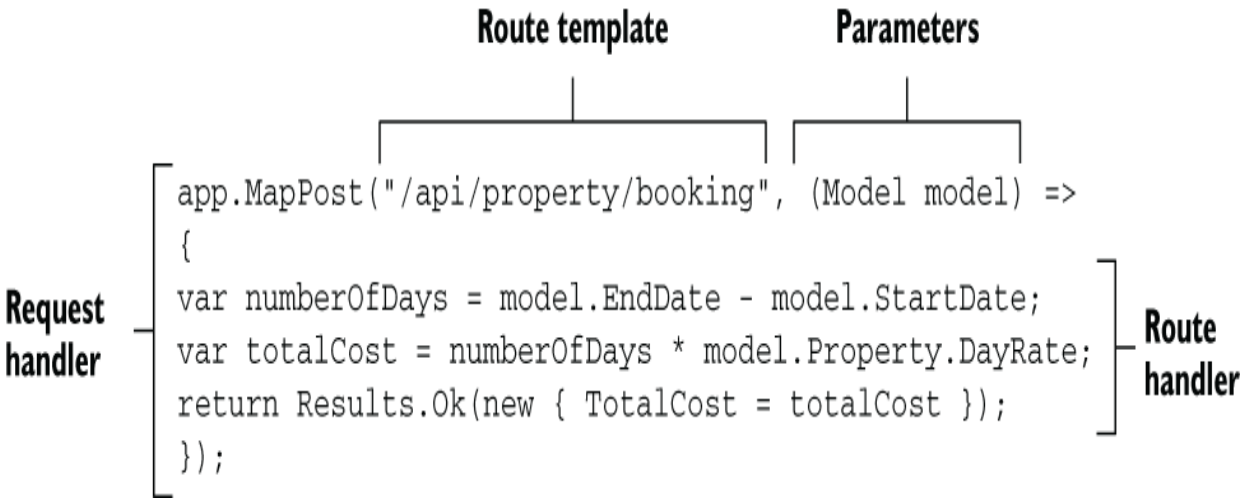


Figure 11.5 Anatomy of a minimal API request handler. This is a nonoperational, slimmed-down version of the actual request handler you will build, designed purely to illustrate the moving parts.

The route handler can be configured to return one of many built-in response types, including JSON, text, and files. The obvious omission from the built-in return types is HTML. That's what Razor Pages is for.

11.3.1 An example minimal API

In the next exercise, you will migrate the current booking page handler to the minimal API approach. You will define an endpoint that responds to `POST` requests at /api/property/booking. It takes a `BookingInputModel` as a parameter and returns a JSON response. Open the Program.cs file, and just before `app.Run()`, add the lines of code from the following listing.